SMM IRON ORE DAILY

SMM Iron Ore Daily

2026-10-15 Thursday · Imported & Domestic Ore · Prices · Supply–Demand · Inventory · Commentary

Source **SMM / SGX**

Futures Contracts

SGX: latest price · DCE: close

SGX Iron Ore Current-month Contract Latest price

90.30 USD/dmt

FEFV26 · 2026-10 · SGX

As of preparation: 2026-10-15 17:58:50 (UTC+8)
Quote time: 10-15 17:40:00 (UTC+8)

DCE Iron Ore Most-traded I2701 Daily

671.5 yuan/mt

▼ -2.5 -0.37%

MTD avg **678.4**

As of Oct 15 · vs Oct 14

SMM Iron Ore Price Index

Five MMi indices as of Oct 15

Index	Value	Change	MTD avg
MMi 61% Port Spot Daily	**654** yuan/wmt	▼ -2 -0.30%	659
MMi 58% Port Spot Daily	**615** yuan/wmt	▼ -2 -0.32%	621
MMi 65% Port Spot Daily	**813** yuan/wmt	▼ -7 -0.85%	822
MMi 61% Seaborne Index Daily	**88.80** USD/dmt	▼ -0.70 -0.78%	90.67
MMi 65% Seaborne Index Daily	**107.50** USD/dmt	▼ -0.85 -0.78%	109.66
SMM Domestic Ore Composite Index Daily	**821.58** yuan/mt	▼ -3.22 -0.39%	823.19

As of Oct 9 · vs Oct 8

Key View

Futures and spot prices weaken as port stocks rise; purchasing support remains key

Prices softened broadly again, with yesterday's recovery in some seaborne brands failing to continue. DCE most-traded fell to 671.5 yuan/mt, while the 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 654, 615 and 813 yuan/wmt. The seaborne 61% index was USD 88.80/dmt and the 65% was 107.50, with all 12 brands declining. The port high-low spread narrowed to 198 yuan/wmt as the composite high-grade index came under greater pressure this period.

Inventories offer another perspective. Ten-port stocks rose 1.0047 million mt from Sep 30 to Oct 15, with increases in fines and lump and declines in concentrates and pellets. The mix may reflect both cargo arrivals and mill collection or blending schedules, so the figures alone do not establish a change in demand. The latest hot metal decline narrowed but had not turned into growth, leaving prices dependent on physical buying support.

Cost relief and demand support remain in tension in the near term. Lower coke prices and freight ease some costs, but end-user orders and finished-steel margins determine whether mills can restock persistently. Needs-based buying could leave rising stocks constraining a recovery; stronger trading supported by margin improvement would offer a firmer floor. A soft, range-bound outlook remains appropriate while watching the persistence of transactions.

Today's Highlights

- **Futures and port spot prices declined further.** DCE most-traded I2701 closed at **671.5 yuan/mt**, down 2.5 yuan (-0.37%). Qingdao PB Fines were 640, Newman Fines 643 and Mac Fines 644 yuan/wmt, each down 3 yuan; Carajas Fines fell 4 yuan to 825.
- **Both seaborne indices and all 12 brands moved lower.** The 61% index was **USD 88.80/dmt**, down 0.70 (-0.78%), and the 65% was **107.50**, down 0.85 (-0.78%). All 12 brand quotations fell from the Oct 14 report, with PB Fines at 89.15, Newman Fines 88.20 and Mac Fines 88.55 USD/dmt.
- **The port high-low grade spread narrowed.** The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 654, 615 and 813 yuan/wmt, down 2, 2 and 7 yuan. The 65%-58% spread narrowed from 203 to 198 yuan/wmt as the high-grade index fell more sharply.
- **Ten-port stocks increased from pre-holiday levels, with a mixed product profile.** Total inventory reached **104.0212 million mt** on Oct 15, up 1.0047 million mt from Sep 30. Fines rose 1.0128 million mt and lump 848,400 mt, while concentrates fell 708,500 mt and pellets 148,000 mt.

Qingdao Port Imported Ore Spot Prices

yuan/wmt · tax incl.

Product	10-15 (yuan/wmt)	Daily change / %	MTD avg	Last 12 months
PB Fines 60.8% Daily	640	▼ -3 -0.47%	647	
Newman Fines 61.2% Daily	643	▼ -3 -0.46%	650	*
Mac Fines 60.8% Daily	644	▼ -3 -0.46%	649	
BRBF 62.5% Daily	690	▼ -3 -0.43%	697	
Newman Lump 63% Daily	835	▼ -3 -0.36%	842	
Super Special Fines (SSF) 56.5% Daily	502	▼ -3 -0.59%	509	
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	825	▼ -4 -0.48%	829	
PB Lump 61.5% Daily	826	▼ -3 -0.36%	836	*

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD & MMi Indices

USD/dmt

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD CFR Qingdao

Product	10-15 (USD/dmt)	Daily change / %	10-14
Roy Hill Fines 62% Daily	85.55	▼ -0.65 -0.75%	86.20
SIMEC Fines 61% Daily	87.25	▼ -0.65 -0.74%	87.90
PB Fines 62% Daily	89.15	▼ -0.65 -0.72%	89.80
Newman Fines 60.7% Daily	88.20	▼ -0.70 -0.79%	88.90
Mac Fines 60.5% Daily	88.55	▼ -0.70 -0.78%	89.25
Jimblebar Fines 60.30% Daily	85.20	▼ -0.45 -0.53%	85.65
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	104.70	▼ -0.40 -0.38%	105.10
SSFT / SSFG 60% Daily	94.95	▼ -0.35 -0.37%	95.30
Brazilian Blend Fines (BRBF) 64% Daily	94.90	▼ -0.45 -0.47%	95.35
RTX Fines 61% Daily	84.20	▼ -0.55 -0.65%	84.75
West Pilbara Fines (WPF) 60% Daily	88.65	▼ -0.65 -0.73%	89.30
SP10 Fines 59%-60% Daily	77.85	▼ -0.40 -0.51%	78.25

SMM Iron Ore Price Index monthly statistics

Index	Month-to-date avg	MoM	YTD	Unit	Last 12 months
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	90.67	-6.05%	-16.2%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	109.66	-4.16%	-11.4%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	659	-4.75%	-19.6%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	822	-2.06%	-9.6%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 58% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	621	-4.05%	-14.3%	yuan/wmt	
SMM China Domestic Ore Composite Price Index Daily	823.19	-1.83%	-7.3%	yuan/mt	

The seaborne 61% index was USD 88.80/dmt and the 65% was 107.50, both down 0.78%, narrowing their spread from USD 18.85 to 18.70/dmt. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 654, 615 and 813 yuan/wmt, with the 65%-58% spread narrowing to 198 yuan/wmt.

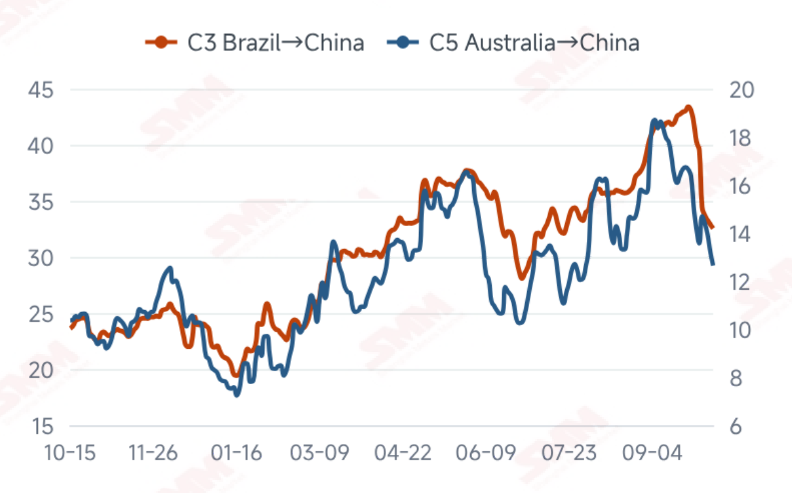
* SMM yuan quotations for Newman Fines and PB Lump start in Mar 2026; their sparklines cover that shorter window only. All others show the past year.

Key Price Drivers

Last 12 months

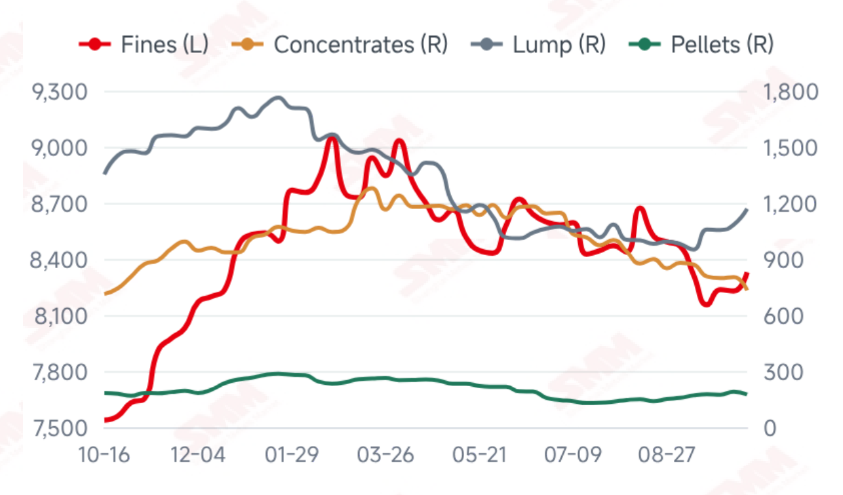
Iron Ore Ocean Freight

USD/mt · daily · last 12M · C3 Tubarão→Beilun/Baoshan, C5 W. Australia Dampier→Qingdao/Beilun/Baoshan



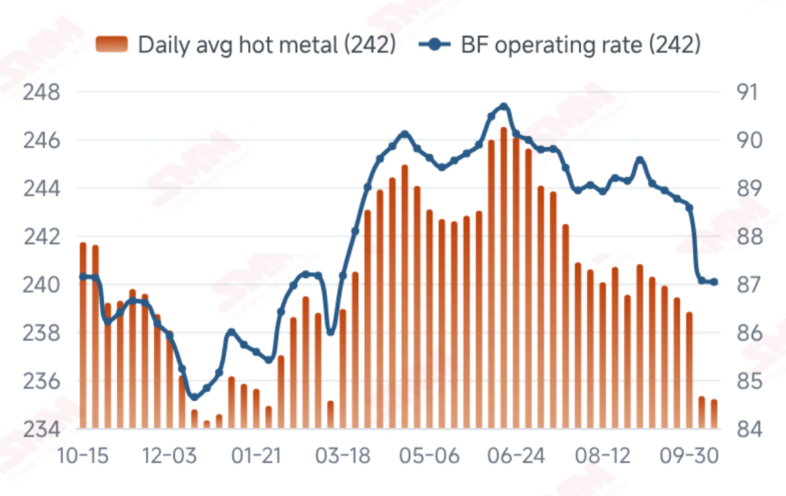
Iron Ore Port Inventory at 10 Ports · by Product

Left: fines Right: concentrates / lump / pellets · 10,000 mt · weekly



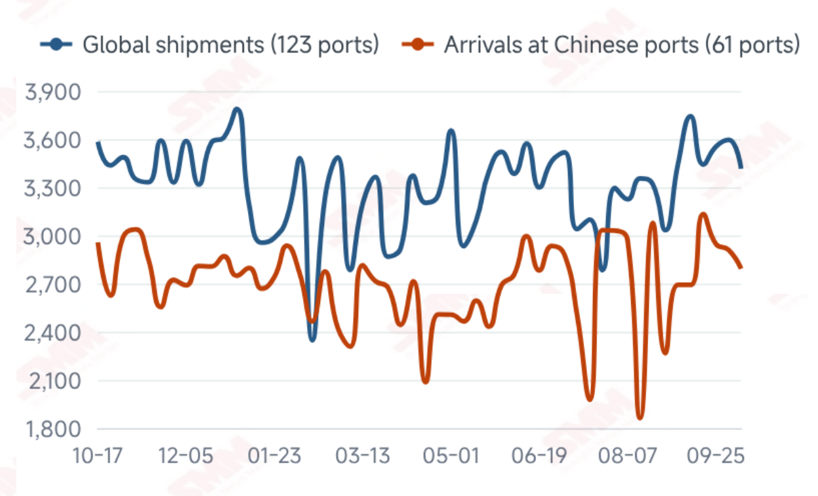
Daily Avg Hot Metal Output & BF Operating Rate, 242 Mills

Left: 10,000 mt Right: % · weekly



Global Iron Ore Shipments vs Arrivals at Chinese Ports

10,000 mt · weekly · shipments 123 ports / arrivals 61 ports



Market Commentary · Imported Ore

Futures & spot	DCE most-traded I2701 closed at 671.5 yuan/mt, down 0.37% from Oct 14. Qingdao PB Fines were 640, Newman Fines 643, Mac Fines 644, BRBF 690, Newman Lump 835, SSF 502 and PB Lump 826 yuan/wmt, each down 3 yuan; Carajas Fines fell 4 yuan to 825. SGX official current-month FEFV26 was last priced at USD 90.30/dmt, timestamped Oct 15, 17:40:00 (UTC+8).
Drivers	After some seaborne brands stabilised yesterday, all 12 quotations declined today, highlighting limited persistence in the price recovery. The port 65% index fell 7 yuan, more than the 61% and 58%, showing differences in short-term pricing across grades. Cost relief may offer a cushion, but price stabilisation still requires sustained mill buying and transactions.
Demand	SMM's latest 242-mill survey showed daily hot metal output of 2.3520 million mt on Oct 14, down 1,200 mt from Oct 7. The blast furnace operating rate fell 0.03 percentage point to 87.03%. A narrower decline does not mean output has recovered. Production and buying appetite remain tied to finished-steel orders, profitability and maintenance schedules; the key is whether cost improvements generate sustained restocking.
Inventory & supply	Ten-port stocks were 104.0212 million mt on Oct 15, up 1.0047 million mt (+0.98%) from Sep 30. Fines at 83.2878 million mt and lump at 11.6747 million mt increased by 1.0128 million and 848,400 mt, respectively; concentrates at 7.3173 million mt and pellets at 1.7414 million mt fell by 708,500 and 148,000 mt. Rising total stocks alongside different product trends may reflect both arrivals and mill collection schedules, rather than demand alone. The latest global shipments and Chinese arrivals, for the week to Oct 9, were 34.1393 and 27.9147 million mt.
Cost & margin	Oct 14 freight was USD 32.53/mt for C3, down 1.06% from the previous reading, and 12.64 for C5, down 4.17%. Lower freight reduces transport costs for some cargoes, but weaker port selling prices may offset part of the benefit. Import trading, coking and steelmaking margins refer to different stages of the value chain and should not be treated interchangeably when assessing buying capacity. SMM's current imported ore cost-and-margin report put the average import margin at 1.10 yuan/mt, down 7.30 yuan from 8.40; whether it turns negative depends on subsequent procurement costs and spot selling prices.

Market Commentary · Domestic Ore

Prices	SMM's Oct 15 Tangshan brief quoted 66% concentrate at 885–890 yuan/mt on a dry-basis, tax-inclusive ex-works basis, relatively stable recently. The latest national Domestic Ore Composite Price Index was 821.58 yuan/mt on Oct 9; the regional quotation and national index measure different markets.
Supply & demand	Mills lowered tender purchase prices while miners and concentrators sold in line with the market. Earlier declines improved the relative value of some domestic concentrates, but mill losses and softer imported ore kept pressure on bids strong. Stabilisation still depends on regional supply, actual trading and mill purchasing intensity.
Outlook	SMM expects Tangshan concentrate prices to remain soft and range-bound near term. Limited margin improvement and needs-based buying could constrain a recovery, while stronger finished-steel orders and persistent restocking could improve support for some resources.

Market Factors

▲ Supportive factors

- The second coke cut offers some relief to mill costs.
- C3 and C5 freight declined further.
- The latest hot metal decline narrowed, although output has not recovered.
- The latest global shipments and Chinese arrivals both fell WoW.

▼ Bearish factors

- DCE, port indices and both seaborne indices declined together.
- All 12 seaborne brands fell, indicating limited persistence in the earlier recovery.
- Ten-port stocks rose 1.0047 million mt from Sep 30.
- Stronger mill buying still needs support from orders and profitability.

Flash News

- Arrivals at ports fell for three consecutive weeks, but port inventories built up; expectations of hot metal bottoming out struggle to offset pressure from high inventory [SMM Iron Ore Daily Review] ↗
  2026-10-15
- [Domestic Iron Ore Brief] Iron ore concentrates prices in the Tangshan area are likely to consolidate on a subdued note ↗
  2026-10-15
- [SMM Coking Coal and Coke Daily Brief] 20261015 ↗
  2026-10-15
- Rio Tinto Q3 global iron ore sales up 3%; Simandou hits ~10 Mtpa run-rate [SMM Iron Ore] ↗
  2026-10-15
- [SMM Steel] Indonesian Slab Steady at $480/mt FOB, Mills May Cut Prices to Win Buyers ↗
  2026-10-15
- [SMM Steel] European HRC Prices Diverge as Weak Demand Limits Further Gains ↗
  2026-10-15

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